

long with a Functional Leaders Meeting within the following days.

There are recurring discussion topics as well as a discussion on content chosen by the CEO.

In addition, the CoS to the CEO is responsible for preparing the CEO for offsites by:

1. Finalizing the agenda to include CEO input
1. Working with the CEO on what to cover in offsite introductions and closings
1. Helping the CEO to prepare for sessions that the CEO will facilitate

CEO Performance Evaluation

In Q1 of a new fiscal year, the Chairperson of the Compensation Committee conducts the annual CEO Evaluation. The Chairperson meets with all members of GitLab's Board and E-Group for their feedback on the CEO's performance over the past Fiscal Year. The Chairperson meets with the CEO for their self-assessment at the beginning of the evaluation cycle.

The CEO's self-assessment is centered on three main areas

1. Areas of Notable Success
1. Areas of Disappointment
1. Areas for Improvement and Focus in the next fiscal year

The Staff EBA to the CEO assists the Chairperson to schedule the performance review meetings with each Board Member (50 minutes, 1:1) and E-Group member (25 minutes, 1:1). These are conducted in an interview format to capture the richest possible feedback regarding the CEO's performance. During these calls, Board Members can expect to share their perspectives on the CEO's major accomplishments and disappointments in areas such as vision, strategy, operations, management team development, company culture, and relationship with the Board. General areas of strength. Areas for improvement and/or additional focus. Key fiscal year strategic/operational, non-financial goals.

The results from the Board and E-Group team interviews are summarized (without attribution) by the Chairperson and shared for discussion at the March Board of Directors meeting.

The CoS to the CEO is responsible for a mid-year and an end-of-year update to the Board on the progress made across focus areas. This will come in the form of a progress scorecard. For example, if one area of focus is "set 3-year strategy", the CoS to the CEO will evaluate whether the activity is on track or needs attention. The scorecard will be updated with a progress score (on track, needs attention, or at risk) and a high-level summary of relevant key activities.

Feedback from the Board will be shared and discussed in the Q1 E-Group Offsite. Progress will be discussed in the Q3 E-Group Offsite.

The CoS to the CEO will also assist the CEO in prepping for the CEO's end of year review and areas for focus in the coming year.

Managing the Functional Leaders

Functional Leaders is a group comprised of all CEO-Skips, select People Business Partners, and

a few other folks as nominated by members of E-Group.
The CoS to the CEO enables and manages this group.

Maintaining the Mitigating Concerns

We outline our Mitigating Concerns in the handbook.
The CoS to the CEO is responsible for maintaining this list.
There is an issue to also add DRIs and review the mitigations.

Supporting Summit Challenge

The CEO chooses to run a Summit Challenge as part of some Summits. The Challenge is shared in advance of Summit or on the first day of Summit. As an example, the 2020 Challenge encouraged team members to beautify docs. The Office of the CEO is responsible for collaborating with the CEO to create and introduce the challenge. The CEO is responsible for identifying a prize for team members, but the Office of the CEO should ensure that a prize is identified and support the CEO in this if needed.

Meeting Cleanup Day

On February 14, or the Tuesday after if this day falls over the weekend or on Monday, we have an annual calendar cleanup day.

The template Slack post includes more information about the purpose and recommended actions:

plain

:googlecalendar: :broom: YYYY-MM-DD is Meeting Cleanup Day!

At the start of each new fiscal year, we have a meeting cleanup day to encourage everyone to look at their calendars and assess the value and frequency of recurring meetings.

With the goals of increasing efficiency and looking at how to make recurring meetings more productive, this practice acts as a reminder to:

1. Cancel meetings or change the frequency if you feel that the current cadence does not add sufficient value
2. Discuss removing yourself as an attendee with the meeting owner if you don't feel that you are contributing or supporting business results through participation
3. Ask other team members to reexamine how existing meetings are managed

If you're looking for possible wording to use when taking the actions above, and for more information about the cleanup day, please look at
<https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/ceo/office-of-the-ceo/meeting-cleanup-day>.

When canceling a meeting, a team member can copy and paste this message to send to attendees: I evaluated the need for this meeting as part of Meeting Cleanup Day. I have determined that the meeting is no longer needed. Please get in touch if you have any concerns.

When changing the cadence of a meeting, a team member can copy and paste this message to send

to attendees:

I reassessed this meeting as part of Meeting Cleanup Day. I have determined that the meeting no longer needs to happen as frequently. Please look for an updated meeting invite and get in touch if you have any concerns.

If you are a team member who intends to decline a meeting, the asynchronous communication section of the handbook has some good suggestions for what to say when you decline.

Meeting Cleanup Day is intentionally near the start of the new fiscal year. The Office of the CEO will launch this initiative annually a week in advance through posting in the whats-happening-at-gitlab Slack channel, and by re-posting a reminder at 00:00 UTC on cleanup day. Office of the CEO (or CoS) will repost in the managers channel for visibility.

Program managing JiHu

A member of the Office of the CEO is the DRI within GitLab for the success of GitLab's partnership with JiHu. Coordination with JiHu requires engagement from multiple functions within GitLab. The Office of the CEO ensures that the appropriate folks are engaged at the right times and that GitLab provides appropriate support to this separate entity.

For example, this member ensures that there is an aligned process among relevant GitLab functions after a customer requests to transit to JiHu:

1. After the Customer's request of novation from GitLab to JiHu is approved, the member of the Office of the CEO opens a new issue as soon as the contract is issued, and assigns the issue to GitLab Accounting department.
1. This issue triggers the Accounting development to update SFDC, Zuora and NS.
1. If there is no issue raised in the month, it means there is no novation in that month.
1. This process takes effects from 2023-02-01, and replaces the previous process that an issue is created each month regardless whether there is novation in the month or not.

Organizational pulse

Due to its cross-functional scope and access to information, the Office of the CEO is uniquely positioned to see what is happening across the company. Members of the Office of the CEO are encouraged to regularly have coffee chats with folks outside of the team and share key insights and feedback from these conversations.

Measuring results

We are evaluating different ways to measure our success as a team. These include:

1. A company-wide team satisfaction score
1. A pulse survey sent to a few targeted folks who have worked closely with the Office of the CEO team members in the past quarter
1. Score against team quarterly goals
1. Score on success in a few top initiatives within a quarter

Chief of Staff Shadow

The Chief of Staff to the CEO may occasionally have a Chief of Staff Shadow, a GitLab team member who will participate in a specific project or initiative for a fixed time. Depending on the project or initiative, the team member may spend most of their time with an Office of the CEO team member instead.

Shadow responsibilities could include: taking notes, providing feedback, and/or supporting the overall initiative success. This role would be in addition to any existing responsibilities at GitLab. Participants would opt in to experience another function within GitLab and contribute to a different part of the business. Since participation would be in addition to an existing workload, managers must sign off before a CoS to the CEO Shadow can participate. Interested team members can share their interest with the Chief of Staff to the CEO in the ceo-chief-of-staff-team Slack channel. The CoS to the CEO will follow up with you to understand what you are looking to get out of the experience and review projects that may be a good match. If there is not an existing project, you will be kept in mind for future opportunities.

Once a project or initiative to Shadow has been identified and the team member decides to participate, the team member should open a merge request to add their name to the below table. The MR should be shared through Slack in the ceo-chief-of-staff-team channel for review and merge. Optionally, the team member can make use of the internship for learning as a framework to guide the Shadow period.

Start Date	End Date	First & Last Name	GitLab Handle	Project/Initiative
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
2020-05-23	2020-08-21	Mike Miranda	@mmiranda	
2020-08-31	2021-07-18	Jerome Ng	@jeromezng	JiHu
2021-06-02	2021-09-01	Samantha Lee	@slee24	Shadow Michelle Lee
2023-03-06	2023-11-01	Cynthia "Arty" Ng	@cynthia	TeamOps and OKRs (internal links)

Important things to note

1. This is not a performance evaluation
1. Plan to observe and ask questions.
1. Participating in the shadow program is a privilege where you will be exposed to confidential information. This is underpinned by trust in the shadows to honor the confidentiality of topics being discussed and information shared. The continuation of this program is entirely dependent on shadows past, present, and future honoring this trust placed in them.
1. Give feedback to and receive feedback from the Chief of Staff to the CEO. Participants in the shadow program are encouraged to deliver candid feedback. Shadows maintaining confidentiality during the program is separate from shadows being able to provide candid feedback.

Quick Links and Fun Facts

- Chief of Staff to the CEO Job Family
- Strategy & Operations Job Family
- GitLab Strategy and Operations (Workplace) Team Handbook
- Performance Indicators
- GitLab Team Project
- Team readmes

- Embody Team

Contact Us

- ceo-chief-of-staff-team on Slack (GitLab Team Members only)

GitLab / Google Groups

The Office of the CEO maintains a GitLab Group and Google Group to ensure the appropriate level of access is granted or removed as team members join and leave the team. The following mapping of permission levels from GitLab Groups to Google Groups is being used:

- 1. Owner -> Owner
- 1. Maintainer -> Manager
- 1. Developer -> Member

As of 2023-08 there's no automatic syncing between these groups so Office of the CEO team members who have the appropriate permission level in each group should add or remove team members as they join and leave the team.

GitLab Project

The primary project used by the Office of the CEO to track work specific to our team is Office of the CEO. Please file issues here as needed to track work being done.

SECTION: ceo/office-of-the-ceo/performance-indicators.md

{{% performance-indicators "chiefstaffteam" %}}

SECTION: ceo/office-of-the-ceo/workplace.md

About the GitLab Strategy and Operations (Workplace) Team

The GitLab Strategy and Operations (Workplace) Team evolved from the All-Remote Marketing team. It is responsible for:

- 1. The creation, curation, and continued iteration of GitLab's guide to all-remote, a deep library of guides that covers every facet of how GitLab functions as a remote team.
- 1. Stewarding, iterating, and evangelizing GitLab's management philosophy and people practice, TeamOps.
- 1. Building an overarching methodology for the modern workplace.

This page is the single source of truth for TeamOps and all-remote positioning, evangelism, approvals, vision, and strategy.

Mission Statement

{{< youtube "GKMUs7WXm-E" >}}

The mission of GitLab's Strategy and Operations (Workplace) team is to define, evolve, and scale TeamOps. We also evolve and champion the company's all-remote culture.

This involves close collaboration with GitLab's CEO and Chief of Staff; Corporate Marketing (PR, corporate events); People Group (employment branding) and Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging.

All-Remote Flywheel

The All-Remote Flywheel is focused on continually evolving and refining GitLab's all-remote environment (e.g. tooling, approach to meetings, collaboration, and communication, total rewards/compensation) in order to drive stronger brand awareness, marketing potential, and thought leadership. If our organizational design principles continue to stay ahead of the curve, we're able to lead marketing conversations on all-remote and the future of work. This also drives happier, more efficient team members, and impacts elements such as time-to-hire and team member retention.

Strong all-remote marketing may bolster industry trust in the GitLab brand and product due to the halo effect. E.g., If The Remote Playbook inspires a firm's remote transition blueprint, said firm is likely to show favoritism to GitLab's product offerings and services.

mermaid

graph BT;

id1(Savvier Operations)-->id2(Stronger Marketing);

id2(Evolving/Refining All-Remote Operations)-->id3;

id3(Happier, More Efficient Team Members)-.->id1(More Users);

id1(Stronger Marketing of All-Remote Leadership)-.->id4(Improved Team Member Acquisition and Retention);

id3-->id1;

id4(Greater Trust in GitLab Brand/Product)-.->id5(Improved Team Member Acquisition and Retention);

id5(Improved Team Member Acquisition and Retention)-.->id3;

Vision

GitLab is an influencer and educator in remote work and people operations. It serves the community by creating valuable content that furthers the proliferation and ubiquity of remote-first and all-remote organizations, while enhancing the operations of colocated and hybrid-remote companies by sharing implementable remote-first practices.

We believe that the people practice and operating principles relied on by GitLab are applicable even to colocated companies, and educating on pillars such as asynchronous workflows and informal communication can benefit all organizations.

Goals (OKR)

Follow our work and collaborate in the TeamOps Q4-FY23 Epic.

The team's KR is defined within GitLab CEO's OKR.

In Q4-FY23, our KR is: Certify at least 100 GitLab team members and 1 person in each department as TeamOps Trainer: Level 1

TeamOps Trainer

TeamOps is how GitLab works. It is an operations model that helps teams maximize productivity, flexibility, and autonomy by managing decisions, information, and tasks more efficiently.

TeamOps Trainers are team members who are internal champions of GitLab's values, operating principles, and ways of working, inclusive of all functions and departments. They aspire to mentor and share with others GitLab's ways of working, both inside and outside of the organization.

A TeamOps Trainer transitions through three stages of TeamOps understanding. 1) Recall => 2) Apply => 3) Teach

In Q4-FY23, we are hosting TeamOps Trainer Pilot Workshops.

The purpose of the first version of this program is to collect feedback and resources as part of a larger go to market strategy, including:

- Focus Group · Content testing, feedback, and iteration as beta test before TeamOps is released to the public market with a more formal sales strategy.
- Content/Model Prototyping · Test the viability of creating a network of TeamOps representatives for future phases of TeamOps growth. ("Train the Trainer")
- Content Creation · Scale content related to TeamOps by empowering all of GitLab to contribute blog posts and social threads.

Creation of and participation in this program also supports the FY23-Q4 OKR to Grow Careers of GitLab team members.

Apply to become a TeamOps Trainer and learn more about the program in this GitLab issue.

Requirements for TeamOps Trainer: Level 1

1. Complete the TeamOps practitioner course
1. Be able to answer questions (interview by existing trainer)
1. Enthusiastic presentation of about 3-5 minutes on advantages of TeamOps on YouTube (GitLab Unfiltered)
1. Contribute proposals to the materials (1+ MRs) on iterating TeamOps content to be market-ready (e.g. more applicable to your specific team or function)
1. One blog post (or similar) published on GitLab, LinkedIn, Medium, Twitter thread, etc.

Evangelism Materials

Anyone can be a remote evangelist! Help yourself to these materials for your presentations,

blogs, and consultations.

Remote Work Essentials {gitlabs-guide-to-remote-work}

We're often asked to share how GitLab thrives as an all-remote team. Here are the foundational resources you can share to start the conversation:

- GitLab's Guide to Remote Work is a comprehensive overview of what "all-remote" really means, how it works at GitLab, some tips and tricks for remote teams, and resources to learn more.
- The Remote Playbook, a curated eBook with GitLab's top advice for companies transitioning to remote, can be downloaded via a prompt on the all-remote homepage, accessible at <https://allremote.info/>
- This blog post · Resources for companies embracing remote work · gives background and context, and lays out a logical flow of links for leaders and workers to follow as they learn.

In scenarios where you need a quick link to vocalize, tweet, email, or otherwise share, we have established a memorable redirect: <https://allremote.info/> ("All Remote Dot Info")

Why remote?

GitLab's overview video on its all-remote culture can be viewed [here](#).

Presentations (slide deck)

GitLab's Workplace team collaborated with Brand and Corporate Communications to create a TeamOps Presentation Template on Google Slides, entitled Making Teamwork an Objective Discipline. Please make a copy of this presentation to edit photos and names, personalizing it to your specific need.

You may be asked to give a presentation on how GitLab works as an all-remote team, including requests that are specific to your role (sales, engineering, finance, people, etc.).

In these instances, you're welcome to use this Google Slides presentation, Managing a Thriving Remote Team: A foundational toolkit. (This link is only viewable by GitLab team members.) A suggested script following this presentation is available for your use.

For a video of GitLab's Head of Remote walking through this presentation to a group of founders, click [here](#). This presentation will serve as a guide to narrating the slides and connecting GitLab's approach to remote with the current reality of your audience.

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Expand this section for more slide decks you can use.

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GitLab remote work starter guide · adjusting to work-from-home for workers with suggested script

<a href="https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1XC0eysmulmfvdTy81IVaZ98mRqrX2IGX3jCISWc

04/editslide=id.g8164dec4ba0215">GitLab remote work company emergency plan · what to do and where to start for team leaders with suggested script
Implementing and reinforcing remote-first practices · shared at GitLab Culture Open House 2020
GitLab Team member slide deck from Festival of Work in EMEA, "sure you remote, but do you async?"

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Usage guidelines:

1. Please make a copy of the presentation and script instead of overwriting the template.
1. Swap out existing names/headshots for your own.
1. Feel welcome to add a slide or two related to the specifics of the request.

Teaching other companies how to go remote

{{< youtube "uqPigmWzZRI" >}}

For a glimpse at how GitLab's Strategy & Operations (Workplace) team speaks about remote through presentations, watch the embedded video above or visit the GitLab Unfiltered (YouTube) links below. These presentations were shared at GitLab Connect EMEA in March 2021.

1. Remote Teamwork: How to thrive in a post-office world
1. Making Remote Work

GitLab is unique in that every single team member is remote. All-remote is the common thread that we all share, regardless of what department we serve. This means that each GitLab team member is uniquely equipped to share best practices with other leaders and companies.

The requests may be varied, from small firms looking to unwind their office strategy and go all-remote, to multi-nationals which are looking to implement remote-first best practices to account for more of their team working outside of the office (or in different offices).

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Top questions from suddenly or newly-remote companies
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<p>It is useful to empathize with those you speak with. GitLab is a very advanced remote work environment, making it all the more important for team members to understand alternative baselines and speak to other realities, all while forecasting what's possible if an organization invests in remote-first principles today.</p>

<p>Below are the most common questions asked by suddenly or newly-remote companies, linked to relevant handbook pages that you can study prior to presenting. These shed light on their challenges, and will help you proactively speak to common needs, misconceptions, and

struggles.</p>

How do you maintain and build company culture in a remote work environment?

How do we maintain and build new work relationships without seeing each other in-person on a regular basis?

How do we prevent burnout, isolation, and mental health crises?

How do we combat Zoom fatigue (e.g. exhaustion associated with nonstop video calls)?

How do we handle compensation changes if people permanently relocate to work remotely?

How do we ensure that employees are productive when we cannot physically see them?

How does one become a great remote manager?

How do you effectively lead remote teams?

How do you onboard and train/educate remotely?

How do you collaborate and whiteboard remotely?

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Key Points to Cover {foundational-presentation-areas}

Regardless of the nuance in the request, here are the foundational areas that should be covered. Be sure to describe how GitLab implements these tactics using low-context communication, leaning on examples and detail such that a non-GitLab company can envision how such a tactic could be useful in their own organization.

1. Forced work-from-home isn't remote work. In speaking with suddenly or newly-remote companies, preface everything with the following sentiment: Forced work-from-home, triggered by external factors such as a global pandemic, is not the same as intentionally designed remote work. It is vital to disentangle the two concepts. The stress one feels from working at home with no preparation · possibly with a significant other also working from home while juggling childcare or virtual schooling · is more closely linked to life during a pandemic than it is remote work.

1. Set the stage. GitLab is the one of world's largest all-remote companies, which is why our advice matters.

1. Remote requires a different mindset. All the tools and processes in the world will falter if leadership doesn't lead with trust and transparency rather than micromanagement and fear.

1. Lead with data. GitLab's Remote Work Report surveys thousands of global remote workers. As leaders and team members grapple with going remote, this report provides insights on what matters to those who adopt this way of working, charting a path for building culture around autonomy and flexibility.

1. Remote-first practices aren't just for remote companies. Empathize with challenges. Offer up common issues that teams who are going remote will face. Although GitLab is all-remote, we should make clear that our advice applies to colocated companies and hybrid-remote companies as well.

1. How do I manage a remote team?

- What tools do we need?
- How much communication is too much?
- What is in charge of our remote transition?

1. Guidance is about the here-and-now, but approach this for the long-term.

- Recognize that companies forced into work-from-home need communication gaps filled now.
- The reason to do this with intention is that it will become a core part of a company's

talent and operational strategy.

- Remote de-risks a company, making it less susceptible to socioeconomic swings and crises.

1. Three biggest challenges!

- Workspace challenges and work/life separation.
- Communications in a remote world, and keeping everyone engaged/informed.
- Mindset and culture, leaning into the reality that change takes time, and a focus on

iteration.

1. How does GitLab do it?!

- This is your moment to showcase specific examples of how GitLab does things differently.

If you are addressing an department-specific audience (sales, engineering, HR, finance, etc.), surface examples germane to that audience.

- Feel welcome to share that GitLab uses GitLab. It's a tool built by an all-remote team to enable remote practices such as asynchronous workflows and prevent typical challenges such as communication silos.

- Share our GitLab for remote teams solutions page.

- Prepare for minds to be blown. These things feel like second nature to GitLab team members, but are revolutionary to most.

1. You must have a single source of truth

- It's not about blanket documentation. It's about working handbook-first.
- Start now! Designate a scribe if you have to. Start small, as an FAQ, and build it out.
- Show an example of a handbook page · a great example is our Communication page.

1. Asynchronous over synchronous

- Explain how GitLab requires each meeting to have an agenda and someone documenting.
- Explain how meeting takeaways then need to be contextualized and added to relevant

handbook pages.

- Explain how this added burden on meeting is a forcing-function to work first in GitLab, and rely on a meeting as a last resort.

1. "OK, but where do we start?"

- Start small, don't be overwhelmed. Get your executives out of the office and have EA's document the communication gaps that emerge. (Hint: That's your priority list of what voids to fill.)

- Establish a team responsible for communication. Everything that comes next requires clear, frequent, transparent communication and an understanding of where to communicate and who are the DRIs for various functions.

- Provide a feedback mechanism. It's impossible to know everything, so ask your team members what's missing in their remote approach. Prioritize those asks as you see themes forming.

- Remind people that GitLab has two Getting Started guides: one for leaders/companies, another for workers.

1. Minimize your tool Stack. The fewer moving pieces when transitioning to remote, the better.

GitLab (the product) is at the heart of our workflows.

1. "But wait, I still need help!" Fret not! GitLab's entire library of remote guides are available at <https://allremote.info/> ("All Remote Dot Info")

In case you as a subject matter expert are invited to write an Unfiltered blog post or create other written content, please feel free to make a copy of the "Going remote in " blog post template and tailor based on your audience.

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More examples of how to talk about remote work

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<p>If you're looking for examples of the GitLab team describing our experience with remote work, have a listen at the podcasts below.</p>

The Future of Work Project · Darren Murph // Unlocking the Super Powers of Remote, and its Positive Effects on Families

HR Leaders Podcast · How GitLab Creates and Sustains Scalable Remote Practices

SafetyWing Podcast · How to transition to remote

The Recruitment Network Podcast · The Future of Remote Working with Darren Murph

Wise Up with Cristina Podcast - Darren Murph, Remote Rebel, on Opportunities Beyond Work

Changelog Podcast · Creating GitLab's remote playbook

OpenFin MVP Podcast · All-remote before it was mandatory with GitLab's Brendan O'Leary

Skills for Mars · Darren Murph On Transparency, Values & Leadership when All-Remote

Bright & Early Podcast · Darren Murph: Remote Work at GitLab

Working Without Borders: The Get on Board Podcast · Darren Murph on leading a remote culture at GitLab

Outside The Valley: Darren Murph of GitLab - Why Companies Should Go All-Remote

Accelerating Support Podcast: Darren Murph, Head of Remote at GitLab

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'How to Manage a Remote Team' course on Coursera

Mention in panels and consultations that GitLab's expertise in managing a remote team can be digested as a free course on Coursera.

The course, titled "How to Manage a Remote Team," provides a holistic, in-depth analysis of remote team structures, phases of adaptation, and best practices for managers, leaders, and human resources professionals. It is being offered free of charge, with an optional paid certificate available.

GitLab Remote Work Foundation Certification

Anyone in the world (yes, this includes those who are not employed by GitLab) may take the GitLab Remote Work Foundation Certification and TeamOps practitioner certification to improve their remote fluency.

Social media assets and guidelines

This is the issue to get everything you need in order to evangelize remote work on your social media accounts. It includes:

- Goals
- Perspective
- Hashtags to use
- Topics to follow
- Tips for writing your own posts
- FAQ

How does a company create their own handbook?

Learn more in GitLab's Handbook-First Documentation guide about how GitLab (the company) uses GitLab (the product) to build and maintain its handbook, as well as tools and tips for other companies who wish to start their own.

All-remote guide creation

GitLab's growing library of remote guides is designed to be bolstered by new pages. Below is an overview of the process for adding a new guide.

1. Check this GitLab Issue to ensure that your proposed guide isn't already being scheduled
1. If it's a net-new idea, please put each new guide idea/topic in a new issue within Corporate Marketing
1. Put Proposal: [NEW ALL-REMOTE GUIDE] as the subject
1. Add the label mktg-status::triage
1. Assign to @streas to evaluate and provide feedback

What's the difference between an all-remote guide and a traditional GitLab handbook page?

See below for an A/B comparison of how an inward-facing GitLab handbook page is written vs. an external-facing all-remote guide is written.

- Handbook Hiring Page and Handbook Learning & Development Page (The audience is clearly GitLab, serving as an internal process guide for team members to follow.)
- All-Remote Hiring Guide and All-Remote Learning & Development Guide (The audience is external readers, written as an instructive guide for external companies.)

Design and illustration assets

GitLab's Brand and Digital Design team are building out images and illustrations to visualize all-remote.

This section will be refreshed upon completion of the FY23 remote work brand refresh.

Approvals

Any GitLab team member is welcome to offer 1:1 advice or consultations on remote work. If you're asked to give a broader presentation or webinar to a group, private or public, please create a new issue in Corporate Marketing.

An example of these details in an issue can be found [here](#).

Please be sure to wait for approval before you confirm, if possible. Review this guidance on speaking about GitLab before your engagement, and ask the Corporate Communications team if you have questions. (This document is only viewable by GitLab team members.)

Once you have done this, please share in the teamops Slack channel.

The team will be available to help direct if you feel unprepared, or pair the creator of the issue with someone else on the GitLab team if there's opportunity to add another layer of expertise (e.g. a DevOps expert, an HR expert, a Finance expert) depending on the company that's requesting.

Other assets

The Remote Playbook by GitLab

The Remote Playbook by GitLab is our premier guide to understanding and implementing remote work. It has been downloaded over 150,000 times by leaders and teams across the globe.

GitLab Remote Work Report

GitLab's Remote Work Report sheds light on the current reality of remote work during a critical time in its global adoption. As leaders and team members grapple with going remote, this report provides insights on what matters to those who adopt this way of working, charting a path for building culture around autonomy and flexibility.

For example, 86% of respondents believe remote work is the future and 62% of respondents said that they would consider leaving a co-located company for a remote role. Contrary to popular belief, we found that most remote workers aren't digital nomads, and 52% are actually likely to

travel less than their office working counterparts.

Work-from-Home Field Guide

The Work-from-Home Field Guide was co-created by GitLab and Herman Miller. It combines GitLab's expertise on remote work and management philosophy with Herman Miller's deep understanding of workspaces and design.

Remote Work playlist on GitLab Unfiltered

GitLab is a very transparent company. As such, our AMAs, webinars, and other conversations with team members and other companies are uploaded to a dedicated Remote Work playlist on the GitLab Unfiltered YouTube channel.

Universal Remote webcast playlist on GitLab YouTube channel

Universal Remote is GitLab's weekly web show focused on helping teams transition to a fully remote world. The running playlist of episodes can be found on GitLab's YouTube channel.

All-Remote on the GitLab blog

- GitLab blog posts in the Culture category
- GitLab blog posts tagged remote-work

Our audience

The audience we aim to reach with our all-remote and workplace initiatives is both internal and external to GitLab. It closely aligns with our employment branding audience, and expands to cover key segments in the investor and business communities.

- Venture capitalists
- Entrepreneurs
- Business founders
- Talent, talent acquisition, and HR leads
- Media (business, lifestyle, workplace, finance)
- Educators and researchers
- GitLab team members
- Job candidates and future team members
- The broader GitLab community
- People interested in remote work
- Executives, Managers and HR that are finding a need for resources to support a remote workforce
- Educators suddenly needing to support remote teaching
- Industry analysts
- People suddenly working remotely

Key Messages for All-Remote and Workplace

GitLab: The Remote Strategy

- GitLab is an all-remote company. Hiring managers are able to find candidates not limited to tech hubs like San Francisco, New York or Boston.
- When you can hire around the world, you can pay market wages and offer people an at-market or above-market wage while still reducing costs for the company.
- Without office rent, an organization saves a significant amount of money. GitLab, for example, has experienced rapid growth and would've had to move offices seven times in the last few years. We save a significant amount of money on rent, utilities, office equipment, and additional team members to manage the office.
- GitLab has grown from 350 employees at the beginning of 2019, to over 1,600 employees across 65+ countries and regions currently.

We chose the all-remote structure so we can hire people irrespective of location and we're able to find the most talented people in the world rather than within a commutable distance.

Best practices for managing teams and communications remotely

Managing your team

- Prioritize impact over activity
- Don't require people to have consistent set working hours or say when they're working
- Don't encourage or celebrate working long hours or on weekends
- Encourage teamwork and saying thanks

Communication

- Encourage people to write down all information
- Allow everyone in the company to view and edit every document
- Consider every document a draft, don't wait to share until it's done
- Use screenshots in an issue tracker instead of a whiteboard, ensuring that everyone at any time can follow the thought process
- Encourage non-work related communication for relationship building
- Encourage group video calls for bonding
- Encourage one-on-one video calls between people (as part of onboarding)
- Host periodic summits with the whole company to get to know each other in an informal setting

Connecting to GitLab's values of iteration and transparency

Iteration

- We do the smallest thing possible and get it out as quickly as possible. If you make suggestions that can be excluded from the first iteration, turn them into a separate issue that you link. Don't write a large plan, only write the first step. Trust that you'll know better how to proceed after something's released. You're doing it right if you're slightly embarrassed by the minimal feature set shipped in the first iteration.
- This value is the one most underestimate when they join GitLab. The impact both on your work process and on how much you achieve is greater than anticipated. In the beginning, it hurts to make decisions fast and to see that things are changed with less consultation. But frequently the simplest version turns out to be the best one.

Transparency

- Be open about as many things as possible. By making information public we can reduce the threshold to contribution and make collaboration easier. Use public issue trackers, projects, and repositories when possible.
- An example is the public repository of our website that also contains our company handbook. Everything we do is public by default, for example, the GitLab CE and GitLab EE issue trackers, but also marketing and infrastructure.
- Transparency creates awareness for GitLab, which allows us to recruit people that care about our values. It gets us more and faster feedback from people outside the company, and makes it easier to collaborate with them. It's also about sharing great software, documentation, examples, lessons, and processes with the whole community and world in the spirit of open source, which we believe creates more value than it captures.

Connecting GitLab sellers to individuals

At times, our remote team members speak with GitLab prospects on joint media panels, interviews, webinars, etc. focused on the topic of remote work. If appropriate, the GitLab team member with the contact should consider introducing the prospect to the GitLab sales member. In order to make this connection to the GitLab seller (if it is not known to the All-Remote team member), the All-Remote team member should open an issue in the Field Marketing project and tag the correct regional Field Marketing leader.

Field Marketing will look up account ownership in SFDC (Salesforce.com) and make the connection between the GitLab seller and the All-Remote team member so they can establish next steps in connecting to the prospect. The All-Remote team member should also feel comfortable asking about account ownership in the fieldmarketing or sales Slack channels before opening an issue.

Channels

Web

The team's primary home for publishing informational guides and content is the all-remote section of GitLab's handbook. This will be the preeminent home to all-remote content, positioned for consumption by media, investors, prospective customers and candidates. This links readers to the guides that make up The Remote Playbook, as well as TeamOps. Future web experiences are being evaluated.

Video

GitLab is a very transparent company. As such, our remote-centric AMAs, webinars, and other conversations with team members and other companies are uploaded to a dedicated Remote Work playlist on the GitLab Unfiltered YouTube channel.

Events, panels, keynotes and webinars

All-remote and Workplace events should elevate GitLab as a thought leader in the remote work space, create new partnerships, generate leads and generate media interest/coverage. We will

consider physical events, virtual events and events that combine an in-person presence with a livestream option.

We believe that all-remote is for everyone, and that almost every company is already a remote company. This includes all company sizes, from solo enterprises to multi-nationals, and geographies. Our event strategy should reflect this, offering education, insights, and actionable advice that applies to a wide spectrum of remote companies.

Events should create an inclusive atmosphere, welcoming and beneficial to those who are not receptive to remote or are working in a company where remote is not feasible/acceptable.

REMOTE by GitLab

We gathered the workplace design community in June 2021 for REMOTE by GitLab, a half-day symposium exploring the future of workplace design, strategy, and culture. Learn more about the event, and watch the recorded sessions.

This epic outlines the workstreams associated with bringing REMOTE by GitLab to life.

Social media

We incorporate all-remote content on GitLab's social media accounts, and are investigating a visual approach to new mediums that are aligned with culture and lifestyle stories.

We are working with talent branding to surface relevant all-remote stories from GitLab team members to talent acquisition channels and review sites, such as Glassdoor, LinkedIn and Comparably.

There are also a number of videos on GitLab's YouTube channel that relate to working here:

- GitLab Unfiltered Remote Work playlist
- Everyone can contribute
- Working remotely at GitLab
- This is GitLab
- What is GitLab?

How to contribute (working with us)

To contribute an idea or proposal to further GitLab's all-remote mission:

1. Please put each new idea/topic in a new issue within the Office of the CEO project
1. Put Proposal: [IDEA] as the subject
1. Assign to @streas
1. Please set a due date using GitLab's Due Date feature and provide context for the deadline(s).

Requesting guidance

To request guidance on a panel or speaking engagement:

1. Provide an overview of the opportunity, and whether you or someone else is being requested, in the remote Slack channel (for remote engagements) or ceo-chief-of-staff-team Slack channel (for broader/more general engagements)

1. We will evaluate the opportunity and provide guidance; if we decide to proceed, the participating GitLab team member will be asked to create an issue using this Corporate Marketing issue template to track progress.

Async weeks

In 2021, the All-Remote team began pilot testing asynchronous work: every sixth week, the team blocks our calendars and declines all non-critical meetings. 1:1 meetings are carried out asynchronously via a process detailed in the All-Remote Async Guide.

The goal of this initiative was to create dedicated space for deep work and creative brainstorming. We encouraged other teams to join us or to find other ways to implement asynchronous workflows.

The pilot test was a big success, inspiring not just GitLab team members (see Sam Beckham's blog) but even other companies: for example, Twitter adopted Focus Weeks.

<div class="center">

<blockquote class="twitter-tweet"><p lang="en" dir="ltr">It's day 4 of Focus Week for my team where we cleared all meetings (except for a few critical) and do all work async. The feedback so far is·incredible

Productivity·
Zoomed-out thinking ·
Prioritization ·
Focus (duh) ·
Collaboration ·
Sanity ··</p>— Leslie Berland (@leslieberland) September 23, 2021</blockquote> <script async src="https://platform.twitter.com/widgets.js" charset="utf-8"></script>

</div>

We will continue Async Weeks as a regular process for 2022. Our challenge is to reduce synchronous meetings, not to reschedule them. If your meeting with an All-Remote team member is declined during an async week, we encourage you to:

1. Consider whether the discussion can be conducted asynchronously instead
1. Look for opportunities to combine this discussion with others in a single meeting
1. Reschedule only if there are no workarounds

To read more about the results of the Async Weeks pilot, see this slide from the All-Remote Group Conversation (GitLab team members only).

For a good template to roll this out for your team, see the Growth team's planning and feedback issue. If you have additional feedback on this initiative, please let us know in the all-remoteaction Slack channel. We appreciate hearing your thoughts and ideas.

Team

Contact us

- Slack: Find us in remote, teamops, and ceo-chief-of-staff-team

Return to the Office of the CEO Handbook.

SECTION: ceo/office-of-the-ceo/embody-team/_index.md

The Embody Team is a small team focused on experimental functionality.

Vision

To discover and develop the next generation of DevSecOps innovations through fearless experimentation and rapid iteration.

Priorities

Our current priority is to understand which observability functionality users want to use in GitLab.

Projects

- Experimental Observability

Contact

- General Slack: embody-team

All Team Members

- Dakota Dux
- Renée Hendricksen
- Sid Sijbrandij

Labels

- group::embody

PTO

We follow the Engineering process for taking time off and GitLab team members Guide to Time Off.

Skills

Because we have a wide range of domains to cover, it requires a lot of different expertise and skills:

Technology skills	Areas of interest
Ruby on Rails	Backend development
Go	Backend development
Vue, Vuex, React	Frontend development
GraphQL	Various
SQL (PostgreSQL)	Various
Docker/Kubernetes	Various

Everyone can contribute

At GitLab our goal is that everyone can contribute. This applies to GitLab team members and the wider community through community contributions. We welcome contributions to any and all features, but recognize that first time contributors may prefer to start with smaller features. To support this we maintain a list of quick wins that may be more suitable for first time contributors, and contributors new to the domains in Software Supply Chain Security.

If the contributor needs an EE license, we can point towards the Contributing to the GitLab Enterprise Edition (EE) section on the Community contributors workflows page.

SECTION: ceo/office-of-the-ceo/jihu-support/_index.md

Overview

As announced in the blog post GitLab licensed its technology to new independent Chinese company, GitLab Inc. has licensed its technology to JiHu. This page is outlines how the GitLab Inc. team provides support to JiHu.

Brand

Please refer to our guidelines

Communications

Please refer to our guidelines. Invitations sent to GitLab Team members to join the gitlab-jh.slack.com Slack server are legitimate. This server is used for communications between GitLab Inc. and JiHu.

Sales

Please refer to our guidelines.

Professional Services

Please refer to our guidelines (link to be added).

Customer Support

Process to be added below.

Engineering

R&D Roles

DRI Role
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Mek Stittri Engineering DRI
Kevin Chu Product DRI
Lin Jen-Shin Engineering Facilitator

JiHu engineering contact

MAO Chao is the JiHu engineering contact for GitLab Inc. When GitLab Inc makes changes which requires JiHu to also change, MAO can help coordinate.

Projects

JiHu team projects are located at <<https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/>>. Mirrored projects for gitlab-org tooling and compliance checks are available at <<https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-jh-mirrors/>>.

Even though most of the JiHu projects are moved to JiHuLab.com, some projects are still under the gitlab-jh group.

To request access please reach out to Kevin or Mek to provision.

GitLab Inc Project	JiHu Project
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< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab >	< https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitlab >
< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/license-gitlab-com >	< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-jh/license-gitlab-cn > (private)
< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/customers-gitlab-com >	< https://jihulab.com/jihulab/engineering/customers-jihulab-com > (private)
	< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-jh/cookbook-customers-gitlab-com >
< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-services/version-gitlab-com >	< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-jh/version-gitlab-cn >
< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/omnibus-gitlab >	< https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/omnibus-gitlab >
< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitaly >	< https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitaly >
< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-environment-toolkit >	< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-jh/gitlab-environment-toolkit >
< https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/build/CNG >	< https://jihulab.com/gitlab-

[cn/build/cng-images](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/charts/gitlab-cn/build/cng-images) | [| <https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/charts/gitlab>](https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/charts/gitlab)
[| <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-docs-cn/gitlab-docs-cn>](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-docs-cn/gitlab-docs-cn) | [| <https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitlab-docs-cn>](https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitlab-docs-cn)
[| <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-runner-cn/gitlab-runner>](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-runner-cn/gitlab-runner) | [| <https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitlab-runner>](https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitlab-runner)
[| <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-svgs-cn/gitlab-svgs>](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-svgs-cn/gitlab-svgs) | [| <https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitlab-svgs>](https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitlab-svgs) |
[| <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-qa>](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-qa) | [| <https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitlab-qa>](https://jihulab.com/gitlab-cn/gitlab-qa) |

JiHu contribution process

Please refer to JiHu contribution process for details.

Broken JiHu main branch resolution process

There are times where main-jh branch is broken and requires upstream merge requests to resolve. When this happens the following process will be enacted for a timely resolution within 2 business days of JiHu upstream MR creation.

1. JiHu team will open an upstream MR with the resolution
1. JiHu Engineering DRI will notify GitLab Inc with a message in main-jh-broken to identify that the MR is escalated to the GitLab maintainers
1. GitLab Facilitator will apply ~"JiHu Broken Pipeline" label to the merge request and solicit a review from the appropriate domain (backend, frontend).
1. GitLab Facilitator will notify GitLab Inc team members in the jihu-engineering channel.
1. JiHu will add the MR and root cause of the failure to <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-jh/gitlab-jh-enablement/-/issues/215>

Merge requests with broken JiHu validation pipeline

Check What to do when the validation pipeline failed for more details.

Security Release Process

JiHu is responsible for building and releasing the JiHu Edition each month including all patch and security releases. For security releases, GitLab Inc will continue to follow our existing security release process to publish our security releases. To enable JiHu to build their security releases in a timely manner, GitLab Inc will notify JiHu when a security release is in progress along so that their teams can be on stand by. GitLab Inc will not notify JiHu of the contents of the security release or of the vulnerability.

To notify JiHu of an upcoming security release, please simply post a comment in: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-jh/gitlab-jh-enablement/-/issues/112>

Vulnerability Disclosure Process

GitLab Inc will follow the documented vulnerability disclosure process and will not provide detailed information about vulnerabilities directly to JiHu. No information will be shared

prior to or during an in-progress security release.

Only after a GitLab security release, GitLab Inc may provide JiHu with:

- A link to the public security release blog post
- A link to the GitLab issue describing the vulnerability, which will remain confidential until 30 days after the release in which the vulnerability was patched

This information will be communicated via Slack and the weekly engineering sync with JiHu.

For security vulnerabilities introduced by JiHu contributions, the GitLab Application Security team will share mitigation steps as long as they do not disclose vulnerability details or information that could result in the discovery of vulnerability details.

- If such mitigation steps exist, the GitLab Application Security team will notify JiHu by creating a confidential issue in the JiHu enablement project with the mitigation steps.
- If no mitigation steps exist, the vulnerability will be disclosed as per GitLab's regular security vulnerability disclosure process.

Security Best Practices

GitLab can share security best practices with JiHu. This may include defense in depth measures, hardening techniques, and other information in the interest of keeping GitLab, JiHu, and their customers secure. This can not include vulnerability details or specific remediations that could expose information about an unpatched vulnerability or ongoing incident.

Consulting Process

JiHu benefits from GitLab expertise, particularly around operating GitLab as a SaaS product. GitLab may charge JiHu for consulting on items that require engagement beyond a quick response on Slack. This way, GitLab can safeguard against unplanned work while JiHu builds its domain expertise. This is also agreed upon in GitLab's Technical Services Agreement with JiHu - Internal.

Topics not in scope for consulting

- Reviewing MRs
- Roadmap alignment
- Management collaboration

Product

Role of the Product DRI

The Product DRI has the following responsibilities:

- Provide product management practice guidance to the JiHu CTO and product counterparts
- Enable alignment between GitLab Product and JiHu Product
 - Provide regular updates and raise awareness of GitLab investment themes and roadmap
 - Disseminate JiHu plans and roadmap with the appropriate party

- Liaise with JiHu CTO on product data
- Work with stage groups to implement solutions that pertain to JiHu or China related requirements
- Partner with Engineering DRI and Engineering Facilitators to define and maintain processes that ensure the smooth functioning between GitLab and JiHu

Product Manager responsibilities

JiHu contributions are similar to community contributions. The difference is they are higher in volume and frequency. As JiHu ramps up in the GitLab codebase, they are also eager to build understanding and learn where and how they might contribute to GitLab. Product Managers can share their public directions and work with the JiHu team to help JiHu become self-sufficient and efficient.

At times, product managers are asked to provide feedback or directly respond to specific proposals from JiHu. GitLab PMs should help facilitate collaboration between GitLab engineers and the JiHu team. This means if there's misalignment on product direction, call that out early so JiHu doesn't spend time working on things GitLab doesn't intend to merge.

If product managers need help connecting with JiHu counterparts, ping the Product DRI in jihu-product.

Product Designer responsibilities

GitLab Product Designers are responsible for reviews and guidance and should not take over the complete design work for issues that JiHu wants to contribute, as JiHu has their own Product Design team that will help get these issues ready for implementation.

Process

Once a Product Designer gets pinged on an issue that JiHu intends to contribute upstream, the Product Designer reviews whether that issue already has a clear proposal that does not conflict with our Pajamas guidelines, the Product principles or planned work of their team.

If there is no clear design proposal yet, or there are conflicts with Pajamas or the Product principles, the designer leaves a comment about what is required before the issue should go into implementation.

Milestone Product Planning Process with JiHu

To facilitate collaboration and feedback, JiHu plans ahead of GitLab's milestone planning process to give GitLab product groups time to provide feedback ahead of implementation. The following will happen every milestone:

1. JiHu will create a milestone planning issue in the gitlab-jh-enablement project, such as this example. JiHu typically provides the plan 2 weeks before the 18th of the month.
1. For any items which do not already have an issue in the GitLab.org project, the JiHu team creates an issue. If there is an existing issue, it is linked to from the milestone planning issue. This helps the GitLab product group track JiHu contributions in the same place where other day to day work is tracked.

1. The Product DRI will facilitate awareness and encourage collaboration via the JiHu Milestone Review Template

1. Individual product manager and their engineering counterparts will provide feedback to JiHu as needed

Large Product Initiative Planning

In the interest of creating IP, JiHu will take on larger product initiatives that spans multiple milestones. This type of product initiatives take more coordination. JiHu and GitLab representatives regularly stay in sync regarding these product plans. The goal is to identify large initiatives early so that the appropriate DRIs can be looped in. One example of this type of product initiative is the Visual Builder for the pipeline editor.

What product managers are not responsible for

GitLab Product Managers are not responsible for JiHu product decisions, but collaboration and feedback with JiHu Product Managers is encouraged and appreciated.

- Just like PMs aren't the arbiters of community contribution, product managers are not the arbiter of what the JiHu team works on
- Product managers are not responsible for JiHu product decisions, such as tiering, pricing
- When reviewing JiHu milestone planning:
 - 1. Be aware of JiHu's plans in your product area.
 - 1. Provide guidance in accordance with GitLab's product direction.
 - 1. Help avoid surprises and help JiHu be successful. If feedback will take some time, please provide a heads-up.
 - 1. It is not necessary to provide feedback if there's no feedback to give. JiHu contribution can be the same as other community contributions

Differentiating Proprietary JiHu Features

We differentiate proprietary features for JiHu distributions by including them in the /jh directory. However, the majority of contributions from JiHu team members should be outside of the /jh directory signaling the expectation that most contributions are to GitLab Core and only certain specific features are exclusive to the /jh offering.

Links

- GitLab licensed its technology to new independent Chinese company
- GitLab licensing technology to independent Chinese company FAQ
- China Service Working Group

SECTION: ceo/office-of-the-ceo/jihu-support/jihu-contribution-process.md

Contributions from the JiHu team will follow two methods depending on whether they have JiHu proprietary changes or not.

- Upstream method - start with a merge request in the GitLab Inc. repository.

- Proprietary and upstream method - start with a merge request with all changes against the GitLab JiHu project and a merge request with all non-proprietary changes against the upstream project.

To identify contributions from JiHu, the ~"JiHu contribution" label is automatically applied to all upstream contributions coming from the JiHu team. To ensure the label is accurately applied, the gitlab-jh team must keep the direct members of gitlab-jh/jh-team updated with current team members.

JiHu enablement efficiency age and review metrics are publicly accessible in this dashboard.

The Engineering Productivity team is the DRI for JiHu Engineering enablement efficiency tooling and metrics.

Guidelines for upstream contributions

Contributions that do not involve JiHu proprietary content will be opened against the upstream project.

```
mermaid
graph LR
  mr-->|Opened against upstream project|repo
  mr[Upstream MR]
  repo(GitLab Inc. Repo)
```

Upstream feature contribution guidelines

For large initiatives, ones that take multiple MRs or have broad-range implications, upstream feature contributions are more efficient and predictable when there's joint upfront planning. In order to set up both teams for success they should follow these guidelines:

1. At least one milestone prior to the milestone where implementation starts - JiHu team creates an upstream feature planning issue that provides an overview of the feature scope in English, intended uses, and iterative implementation plan. JiHu will ask the relevant team's PM, Product Designer and EM for feedback on the issue and implementation plan.

- The relevant GitLab product group will provide feedback on the feature, the relevant iterative implementation plan and provide feedback to JiHu.

1. During implementation start - JiHu team will author MRs following the implementation plan and upstream guidelines below. The review will be done based on the agreement in the feature planning issue.

Example upstream planning issue: TBD

Guidelines for iterative contributions

Bigger product feature contributions should follow GitLab iteration strategies.

Iteration training is available to coach on GitLab's value of iteration. This can be helpful to

understand the expectations of GitLab product teams for feature iteration.

Not every features can follow the same strategy, but the first strategy we try should be crafting the minimal valuable change, and for creating merge requests, always try to keep merge requests small.

In the above guidelines to keep merge requests small, we mentioned:

- Horizontal slicing
- Vertical slicing

Given JiHu upstream contributions cannot easily slice horizontally due to lacking developer permissions, always try to slice vertically first, that is, reduce the scope of the feature. Only consider slicing horizontally if it cannot be smaller, while it's still too large to fit inside a single merge request.

Here are some examples for how we break down a feature in multiple iterations, both horizontally and vertically:

Feature	Merge requests (not an exhaustive list)	Slicing
GitLab Insights	- Introduce the GitLab::Insights framework - Introduce the Insights controllers - Insights frontend - Move to supporting multiple charts per page for Insights	Horizontal
	- Introduce the GitLab::Insights framework - Introduce the Insights controllers	Vertical
	- Introduce the GitLab::Insights framework - Introduce the Insights frontend	Vertical
	- Introduce the GitLab::Insights framework - Introduce the Insights frontend - Move to supporting multiple charts per page for Insights	Horizontal